LETTER TO THE HONORABLE WILLIAM F. KNOWLAND,

CONCERNING CHINESE SITUATION.

The Waldorf-Astoria Towers
New York 22, New York
December 31, 1949

Honorable William F. Knowland
United States Senate
Washington, D. C.

My dear Senator:

I have your request for my views on the China situation.

There is merit in the contention that the continuous pressures upon the anti-Communist National Government of China, beginning in 1943, to take the Communists into that government contributed to the breakdown of prestige and strength of Chiang Kai-shek, and the encouragement of Mao Tse-tung. Despite all this, your question still remains. What to do next?

It is my strong belief that we should not recognize the Communist Government of China; that we must continue to recognize and support the National Government; that we should, if necessary, give it naval protection to the possessions of Formosa, the Pescadores, and possibly Hainan islands.

Among many reasons are:

(1) A wall against Communism in the Pacific;

(2) The defense of Japan and the Philippines;

(3) The prevention of the Chinese Legations and Consulates in the United States (and such other countries as agree with us) becoming nests of Communist conspiracies;

(4) The prevention of another Communist permanent member of the United Nations Security Council, with its dangerous implications to that body;

(5) The dangers of Chinese Communist participation in formulating peace with Japan;

(6) By maintaining at least a symbol of resistance, we would have a better basis for salvation of Southeastern Asia;

(7) There would be at least a continued hope of some time turning China in the paths of freedom again.

Yours faithfully,

/s/ HERBERT HOOVER